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Title:
Hot Dog Time Machine

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“Hot Dog Time Machine” by Alan McGuire

(Josh enters through the kitchen door)
Josh: Hey Dad, I--
Dad: Josh, sweetie! Boy does my baby boy have perfect timing. Look--I just knitted you the cutest little outfit! *(Hands Josh a onesie)*
Josh: A onesie? Dad. I'm 17. I'm exactly 17 times too old for this. Not to mention this onesie is smaller than my face.
Dad: Fine. That's fair. I guess you don't love your father anymore!
Josh: Dad...
Dad: I'll just go throw myself off a bridge and die in a river of fire so I don't have to bother you with my love and affection anymore!
Josh: Dad. There's no such thing as a river of fire. Look, I came in here because me and my friends want to go to this concert tonight, and--
Dad: And you told them 'too bad, I'm watching Matilda with my Daders!'
Josh: Actually, I told them my dad needs to stop calling himself 'Daders'. Seriously, why are you always acting like such a…a...
Dad: A what? I’ll tell you what I told you the first time you played with Legos: spit it out, Josh!
Josh: You always act like a clingy mother!
Dad: *(shrieks)* Joshua, that is so sexist! I didn't give birth to you just so you could demean women!
Josh: You didn’t give birth to me, Dad! Look. There's no reason I shouldn't be allowed to go to this concert. I'm leaving for college in a few months. When I'm there, I'll be out doing whatever I want without you around, trying to get me to comb my hair every two seconds.
Dad: But it gets so messy! *(He licks his hand, fixes Josh's hair)*
Josh: *(knocks his hand away)* Dad. I'm too old for you to treat like a baby anymore! There, I said it. Layin' it all out there. You can stop staring at me like a maniac now.
Dad: Joshua Tree-Trunk Madison. I do no such thing! Treat you like a baby, yeah right. Now hurry up and eat this sliced up hot dog and fish sticks before they get cold. Oh, sorry, I forgot...here's a juice-box to wash it down!
Josh: No! Ah! You! Invalid! I'm not a kid anymore, Dad! You know what I'm going to do? I'm going to go down to the freezer in the basement, get a hot dog, microwave it, and eat it whole—like an adult!
Dad: Joshie-poo--
Josh: My name's Josh! Josh Tree-Trunk Madison! Get it right, ugh!
(Josh storms out of the kitchen, heads down the basement stairs)
Josh: “Joshie-poo”? My dad is re-donk-ulous. *(He opens a large freezer)* Why would you ever put hot dogs at the bottom of the freezer? They're like the most important food group. *(Reaches into the freezer)* Come here hot doggie-dogs...ugh, come on, I need to show my dad my manhood. *(Can't reach)* Son of a bratwurst. Dad must have the wingspan of a pterodactyl! Alright, here goes nothing...
(Josh stretches all the way into the freezer. He reaches so far that he suddenly falls into the freezer)
Josh: WHOA!
(The freezer magically explodes with time travel. Once transported, Josh gets out of the freezer)
Josh: Oh my god. That was the hottest freezer I've ever been in! *(Looks around the basement)* Wait. Did Dad redecorate the basement while I was in there?
Dad: *(From upstairs)* Joshie-poo! Your friend Bobby's here!
Josh: Yeah, sure! *(Leaving the basement)* You're not going crazy, Dad. I'm sure it's my friend Bobby that I haven't seen since I was five because he was so stupid he--
(Josh opens the door. His jaw instantly drops)
Josh: Oh my god it's Bobby.
Bobby: Hi! I brought you a stick. *(Hands him a stick)* Wait, I forgot...I brought you two sticks! *(Hands him*

another stick)
Josh: Uh, hi. You're a little kid...
Bobby: Do you want to go eat some Legos?
Josh: First of all, yes. Second of all, I'm pretty sure I got locked in that freezer and am hallucinating this entire experience as I drift into a coma. And thirdly, I'll definitely get arrested if I hang out with a little kid.
Bobby: Wait. Little kids can't hang out with little kids? Are we not supposed to hang out with people our own age? Was I supposed to get in that guy's van--
Josh: Hold on shut up a second...you think I'm a little kid? *(Laughs elegantly)* That is rich! Rich, I say! No dude, I'm seventeen. Just look at my biceps. Plus I almost grew like four hairs on my face the other day. Things are getting pretty serious on my body.
Bobby: That's gross. Do you want to go throw rocks at each other?
Josh: Oh my god, I remember this day. You tried to put a frog in the oven, then I realized that maybe I shouldn't be hanging out with you. Holy sweet lord baby jesus buns...did I go back in time?!
Bobby: *(pause)* Do you want to go put a frog in the oven?
(Dad enters with a tray of cookies)
Dad: Hello boys! Don't mind me--just about to bake you fellas some cookies!
Bobby: Sorry, we need the oven.
Josh: Dad, this is exactly what I was talking about! You never let me do my own things! Here you come, interrupting my play-date with this moronic five year old just to make us some dumb cookies.
Bobby: But that's the only reason I'm friends with you.
Josh: You...wait, what?
Bobby: I only come over because your dad always makes us cookies. Otherwise, I'd never talk to you. Not after you peed your pants in front of the whole school.
Josh: Oh my god, that was like two times! Alright, look. I'm seventeen now, I've got chest hair on the horizon, I don't need any more of this. I'm out.
Bobby: But...but--
Josh: Just put the frog in the microwave, Bobby! The microwave! It makes a cool explosion and you can still eat your cookies. There ya go, you little moron! Bye! Have fun losing a finger in eighth grade!
Bobby: I think I want my sticks back now.
(Josh stares him down, takes out a stick, breaks it. Bobby gasps, Josh takes out other stick, breaks it. Bobby spazzes)
Bobby: Now how am I supposed to scratch my eyelids?!
Josh: I'll see you in twelve years, Dad.
Dad: But, but...the cookies will be cold by then!
Josh: Well...then...why don't you just throw them in your river of fire!
Dad: Josh, there's no such thing as--
Josh: *(Turning to leave)* Back to the future!
Dad: Is a good movie, but--
Josh: BYE!
(Josh exits the kitchen, heads down to the basement)
Josh: Oh my god he is so infuriating. "Let me bake you cookies, Josh. I'm the only reason you have friends, Josh." Who needs that! *(He opens the freezer)* Okay, so I just get back in the freezer and it'll take me back to now. Right? Sure. Work your magic, hot dogs!
(Josh climbs into the freezer and is again transported through time. He climbs out of the freezer)
Josh: Wow. I'm gonna smell like hot dogs the rest of my life. *(Looks around)* Well, the basement looks different...That's a good sign. *(Josh walks out of the basement, stops cold when he sees his middle school friend Cheesefish)*
Josh: Cheesefish!
Cheesefish: Sup.
Josh: Whoa, I haven't seen you since middle school! Oh no, come on hot dog-gods...anything's better

than middle school!
Cheesefish: Like chainsaws!
Josh: Yes, Cheesefish. Precisely. Chainsaws. Man, I don't get why my dad ever made me stop hanging out with you. You have the coolest name ever--
Cheesefish: Cheesefish!
Josh: You have creative and awesome ideas--
Cheesefish: Like when I light things on fire!
Josh: And you...have got something in your hands...
Cheesefish: Chainsaw!
Josh: Oh. Cool! Is that for a science experiment, or...
Cheesefish: I really hate trees today. AHH! *(He chainsaws down some trees)* Stop looking at me, trees! Nobody thinks you're great!
Josh: Yeah, uh...Dude, that's my favorite game to play too...Woo, yelling at trees. You smell, trees! Go back to...the soil! My middle name is in no way related to you.
Cheesefish: Take that, trees! Not so cocky without your faces, huh?
Josh: Man. I'm sure glad they're letting you handle dangerous machinery again. So...when did they let you out of juvy?
Cheesefish: They didn't.
Josh: See? There's nothing dangerous about being friends with you...Just two normal dudes hanging out, chainsawing things...Ye—yeah! Oh god, now what's that?
Cheesefish: *(Holding a firecracker)* Firecracker! I'm gonna blow up that cocky treehouse. Stop looking at me, treehouse! I bet you can't even read! *(Lights firecracker)*
Josh: Cheesefish, no! That's where my dad does his zumba!
Cheesefish: Who cares, you hate your dad like the world hates trees.
Josh: No I don't, leave his treehouse alone! *(Rips away firecracker, throws it into distance)*
My dad was right to make me stop being friends with you. It's taken me seventeen years and a lot of time travel, but I'm finally starting to realize--
Cheesefish: Whoa, sweet throw dude! Right through that cop car's sunroof!
Josh: Oh my god! Cop cars have sunroofs?!
Cheesefish: It's this spoiled generation, man. Oh look, here he comes to say hi! Hi police officer! Yeah, he's the one who made that mad sick throw.
Josh: Stop, what's the matter with you Cheesefish?! You used to be so normal!
Cheesefish: I have an addiction to chaos. It's a disease. Oh cool look how shiny his gun is!
Josh: AH! Hot dogs, get me out of here!
(Josh runs away, rushes into basement)
Josh: Dad, please forgive me!
(He gets into the freezer, travels through time, gets out of the freezer)
Josh: *(Looking around)* Seriously? These hot dogs suck at time travel. Is this even our house? *(Exits the basement to see...)*
Sally: *(crying hysterically)* Josh! You're back!
Josh: Uh, yeah. Back to...where I started, right? Present day? Eh?
Sally: I know we both said some hurtful things, and I'm sorry I ate all the ice cream, but I think we'll have a better marriage because of it--
Josh: Whoa, marriage?! Hold your horses, mamacita. I don't even know you, plus you look way too old for me.
Sally: WHAT?!
Josh: No! I just mean...I can't really marry you, I'm only seventeen...
Sally: You're 17?! And you wait until the morning of our wedding to tell me that?!
Josh: Uh...surprise!...?

Sally: I have spent thirteen days falling in love with you! Baking you cookies, baking you pies, baking you cheesecakes...
Josh: All you do is bake?
Sally: That's not all I do. *(Terrifyingly pulls out a knife)* I'm also a certified butcher. *(raises knife)* And someone just ordered a tender-loin.
Josh: AH! DAD HELP! My wife is trying to bake me!
Sally: Butcher you!
Josh: Different words, same result! AH!
Sally: *(Approaching menacingly)* If I can't have you, no one can! Except for a hungry customer. I think Steve will like you. Or maybe Janet.
Josh: I don't want Steve or Janet to eat me! DAD! I'm sorry I've been such a jerk when you were always just looking out for me. Please help, I need you and always have! Distract her with some baked goods! A cannoli or a pear tart or some pain au chocolat, for example!
Sally: Who are you talking to? Your dad's not here anymore. And I hate pain au chocolat.
Josh: AH! She has terrible taste!
(Josh runs down to the basement, gets in the freezer)
Josh: Please, oh sacred hot dog gods, let me talk to my dad again! Hot dogs, time-travel me!
(The freezer explodes with time-traveling magic. Josh then gets out of the freezer)
Josh: Oh my god! Brainfreeze.
Dad: Uh. Why did you just crawl out of the freezer?
Josh: Dad! Am I back?
Dad: No, you're Josh. *(Laughs heartily)* Oh, I'm a hoot. How long were you in there for? I doubt you beat my record.
Josh: About 30 years.
Dad: And I've still got the crown. Look, Joshie-poo-honey-pie-bear-sweetie-schnookums, I've been thinking. About the concert--
Josh: No Dad, it's fine. I've been a total jerk recently. You have done so much for me...you made me friends as a kid, you've kept me away from danger...Anyway, I know I don't say this much, but I--
Dad: Oh shush shush shush, stop talking shut your mouth. You've gotta get going; you're gonna miss the show!
Josh: Wait. I can go to the concert now?
Dad: Of course, you precious little angel. I don't want my worrying to make you miss out on such a snazzy night. "Death Bloody Rain Slaughter" used to be my favorite band too, you know! Well, second to ABBA of course.
Josh: Obviously.
Dad: Make sure you buy me a t-shirt though. Extra large this time--I want to be able to live in it.
Josh: I'll get you a blood-squirting mask too.
Dad: You just get me.
Josh: But seriously Dad...thanks again. For everything.
Dad: You are welcome, my little pumpkin spice latte! Oh, by the way. Ah, I rhymed! *(Giggles)*
Josh: What Dad.
Dad: Don't eat the hot dogs at the bottom of the freezer. I'm pretty sure they've been in there since the 1850's and could make your brain hallucinate wildly from any contact.
Josh: Right. Radioactive hot dogs. I should've seen that one coming. Unrelated: can you take me to the hospital?
Dad: Anything for you, my little hot dog!
Josh: Please. No more hot dogs.

The End